

UNIT 4 / Build your sentences

What do you do?

Your goal: Build sentences with regular present-tense verbs.

01 Learn the idea

Many German verbs end in -en in the dictionary: lernen, wohnen and machen. Remove -en and add a personal ending: ich lerne, du lernst, er lernt, wir lernen, ihr lernt, sie lernen. The polite Sie uses the same verb form as wir and plural sie.

In an ordinary statement, the conjugated verb is the second sentence element: Ich lerne Deutsch. A subject is normally required even when English might use a short note. Practise with one verb and several people before adding many verbs. Some verbs are irregular, so these endings are a starting pattern, not a rule for every verb.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich lerne Deutsch.	I learn German.
Du wohnst hier.	You live here.
Wir machen eine Pause.	We take a break.
Ihr spielt Fußball.	You all play football.
Sie lernen zusammen.	They learn together.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Was machst du?

What are you doing?

Mia

Ich lerne Deutsch. Und du?

I am learning German. And you?

Ben

Ich mache eine Pause.

I am taking a break.

Your real-life mission

Conjugate lernen with ich, du, er, wir, ihr and sie. Then write two sentences about things you do regularly.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich lerne Deutsch.” mean?

- A. I learn German.
- B. You live here.
- C. We take a break.

2. What does “Du wohnst hier.” mean?

- A. We take a break.
- B. You live here.
- C. You all play football.

3. What does “Wir machen eine Pause.” mean?

- A. You all play football.
- B. They learn together.
- C. We take a break.

4. Complete: Wir ____ Deutsch.

- A. lernt
- B. lernen
- C. lerne

5. Who is taking a break?

- A. Mia
- B. Both speakers
- C. Ben

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - I learn German.

“Ich lerne Deutsch.” means “I learn German.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - You live here.

“Du wohnst hier.” means “You live here.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - We take a break.

“Wir machen eine Pause.” means “We take a break.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - lernen

Wir takes the ending -en: wir lernen.

5. C - Ben

Ben says Ich mache eine Pause.

One possible mission response

ich lerne, du lernst, er lernt, wir lernen, ihr lernt, sie lernen. Ich wohne in Berlin. Ich spiele Fußball.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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